

Southern Shift

Just when one thought **Amitabh Bachchan** had done it all, he has signed up his first Malayalam film with Mohanlal. Titled *Kandahar*, the film sees him essay the role of a

father whose son is held hostage on a hijacked plane.

The film is being directed by Major R.K. Ravindran, a former NSG commando, and has Oscar-winning sound mixer Resul Pookutty on board. Ravindran says, "On hearing the story, Bachchan's eyes were filled with tears." Superstars of the south, watch out.



(L TO R) MISRA, RAO, RAHUT AND SINGH

SATYAJIT DESAI

FOUR PLAY

Breaking away from Bollywood, four writers and singers have started a band of their own. Lyricist **Neelesh Misra**, 36, lead vocalist **Shilpa Rao**, 26, lead guitarist **Chintoo Singh**, 45, and composer **Amartya Rahut**, 32, have come together to form Nine. "This is the angst of a lot of Bollywood professionals," says Misra. The ambitious debutants plan to make an album called *Nine Lost Memories* and tour the world. This band seems to be hitting all the right notes.

BHASKAR PAUL/www.indiatodayimages.com



Dream Debut

Sukanya Purkayastha, 22, may look like a schoolgirl but there is nothing childish about the way she sings. The Delhi girl impressed Kailash Kher so much that he agreed to sing with a young female playback singer for the first time in *Karthik Calling Karthik*. Music directors Shankar-Ehsaan-Loy have cast her opposite Kher in a soulful number titled *Kaisi hai yeh udaasi*. "They needed someone who could sing in low bass and I fit the bill," says the social sciences major from Nirmala Niketan, Mumbai. Here's hoping she doesn't remain a one-song-wonder.



SNOW MEN

Indian skiers **Tashi Lundup**, 25, and **Jamyang Namgial**, 24, are all set to make their debut at the Winter Olympics that start in Vancouver this week. The two havaldars of the Indian Army's Ladakh Scouts regiment are posted at the High Altitude Warfare School in Gulmarg. We wish them luck.

NAMGIAL (ABOVE) AND LUNDUP



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